Innovation rationale

Feature F11 — the agent that conducts the interview

Problem statement

A scored interview normally stops when no person is free to sit on the call. The candidate is already in the room, the checklist is locked, and the gaps in the CV are known, but a silent room produces no evidence. A script that reads ten questions aloud would keep the slot, and it would not be an interview: it would not hear an answer, would not notice a question asked back, and would not move on when a topic was actually covered.

Purpose

Feature F11 is the agent that conducts the live interview when a human interviewer is not present. It joins the same video room as the candidate, listens, speaks, and works through the locked checklist. The recruiter does not have to be on the call for the conversation to happen. The result is still a spoken record the later reports can cite.

Architecture

The agent is a LiveKit participant in the candidate’s room. Hearing and voice are loaded on the interview machine before the call. faster-whisper turns the candidate’s audio into text, biased by the checklist and a short CV profile. Kokoro, through kokoro-onnx, speaks the reply. It is the default voice because it sounds closer to a person. Piper, an ONNX voice, speaks only when Kokoro cannot load. The words come from Gemini alone. The spoken turn does not wait on Claude or the local model. Gemini returns a small JSON judgement: what the candidate just did, the one or two sentences to say, whether the open topic was answered, which checklist items that answer covered, and whether the skill quiz should open. If Gemini misses its short budget, the room plays a filler, a nudge, or a request to repeat, synthesized ahead of the call.

Design choices

The checklist is private. The agent never reads a topic label aloud. It asks one concrete situation, prefers gaps the CV did not fully meet, and asks exactly one question per turn. It may use a detail just said, and it may notice a conflict with the CV. It may not invent the company, the team, the salary, or the process; those questions go back to the recruiter. A greeting, a fragment, a request to repeat, and a decline each get a different next line, so small talk does not advance the checklist. When the topics are covered, it invites a question from the candidate and then opens the ten-question quiz. The stored transcript keeps what was recognized, including a messy answer.

Value

This is the piece that lets the hire proceed without a person holding the microphone. Screening can rank a file. Only a conversation can test whether the candidate can explain a failure. The profound part is that the interview stays real without the recruiter in the room: hearing and voice are local, the next question is still bound to the locked checklist, and a missed model call becomes a spoken pause rather than a dead line. The recruiter can be absent. The evidence cannot.